

039 Reveal leaf skeletons

1
DAY

Deciduous leaves have veins that fan out from a large midrib attached to the stalk. The veins carry food to and from leaf cells. Remove the soft parts of the leaf to reveal its "skeleton" framework.



What you need

- Fallen leaves
- Rubber gloves
- Saucepan
- 1 quart water
- 3 tbsp washing soda
- Paper towels



1 Ask an adult to help. Add the water and washing soda to the saucepan. Heat until the mixture starts to boil.

Central midrib



2 Remove the pan from the heat. Carefully drop the leaves into the solution. Let them soak for several hours.

3 Wearing the gloves, put the pan under cold running water and rinse the leaves thoroughly. Washing reveals the veiny skeleton. Dry off with paper towels.

Network of veins

Be careful not to splash hot washing soda on your skin.



040 Take leaf rubbings

10
MINS

Put a leaf onto a smooth surface and cover it with white paper. Hold the paper down, rub over the leaf with a crayon or soft colored pencil. Label each rubbing.

Central midrib

Vein network

